Podocarpus × 'Red Tip'

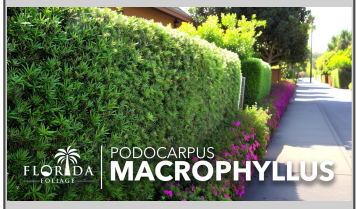
Red Tip Mountain Plum Pine, Red Tip Podocarpus

Also known as: mountain plum pine 'Red Tip' | Family: Podocarpaceae

Overlook: 10 **TOTAL 10**



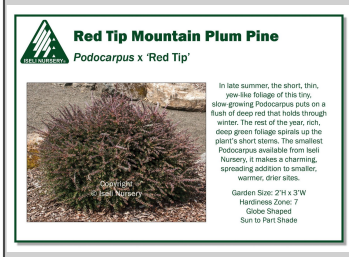
HABIT



OTHER



LEAF



OTHER

QUICK FACTS

Plant Type: Not stated

Evergreen or deciduous
Evergreen

Growth & Size
Rate: Not stated
Size: 2–3 ft (0.6–0.9 m) high × 3–5 ft (0.9–1.5 m) wide.
dwarf (2–4 in per year).
Dense, rounded to spreading/globe habit.
Maturity in 10–20 years

Sun

Water

Soil
Moist but well-drained soil preferred; adaptable to clay or sand if drainage is good

Zone 8a
Hardy in USDA Zones 7–9 (or 7a–10b). Suitable for Atlanta Zone 8a. Prefers warmer, drier sites within range. Can be grown in containers and protected if needed.
Dense evergreen form works well in rockeries or small landscapes

ORIGIN AND CHARACTERISTICS

Origin
Cultivar/hybrid selection, often associated with Podocarpus lawrencei (mountain plum pine from Tasmania/Australia). Selected for red-tipped or red new growth and compact dwarf habit. Trade list it as Podocarpus x 'Red Tip'

Form
Dwarf evergreen conifer with fine, yew-like, narrow leaves (tiny needles ~4 mm). New growth flushes deep red/maroon in late summer/autumn and holds through winter; rest of year rich deep green. Dense, formal, clean habit. May produce small cones/berries on female plants. Hybrid of southern hemisphere Podocarpus species. Smallest Podocarpus available from some nurseries. Dramatic seasonal red flush on tips. Fine texture mixes well with grasses and other small conifers. Adaptable and formal appearance. Poisonous if ingested (typical of genus)

Foliage
Not stated

Flowers and fruit
Not stated

Bark
Not stated

PLANTING NOTES

Establishment

Plant in full sun to light shade with well-drained soil.
Occasional deep watering improves color. Minimal to no pruning needed; dense growth stays tidy. Excellent for rock gardens, borders, containers, or modern landscapes.
Propagate by semi- ripe cuttings. Long-lived

HEALTH

Health

Low maintenance. No serious problems stated. Light deer resistance. Easy to grow. Avoid poor drainage

Symptoms

None stated